

What the experts say

As the Internet of Things (IoT) is revolutionising businesses and technologies, the number of connected devices to the Internet is increasing exponentially. In fact, Gartner estimates the number of connected IoT devices to be around 25 billion by 2020, which in turn is generating massive amounts of data to be processed and mined. Traditionally, it would take time for the data to travel from the device to the centre for processing, and all this data travelling back and forth would also put a strain on the bandwidth. EC offers a solution to this problem by relocating crucial data processing to the edge of the network. EC enabled devices can gather and process data in real time, allowing them to respond faster and more effectively.

—**Gaurav Burman**, VP & APAC President, 75F

As per a report, McKinsey estimates that India will see growth in number of Internet users by about 40 per cent to between 750 million and 800 million by 2023. More Internet connectivity means an unimaginable increase in data. As IoT devices become widespread and more efficient, enterprises will need to adopt successful computing architectures to maximise this technology and potential. By integrating EC with centralised CC services, both methods will optimise capacity while reducing business constraints.

—**Anjani Kommiseti**, country manager, India & SAARC, Raritan & Servotech, brands of Legrand

EC is suitable for operations that have extreme latency issues. It is like a mini data centre helping in decreasing the latency of work. CC is more needed and looked as a solution where flexibility, data recovery, no maintenance, easy access, and increased security are the concerns.

—**Adrian Johnson**, director - Technology, TechnoBind

logistics have also implemented these technologies, and businesses are realising their potential.

Adrian Johnson. Edge computing is benefitting the sectors, where IoT devices are used specifically for profit purposes and utilised across-the-board in every related industry. For example, artificial intelligence (AI), smart cars, manufacturing plants, smart cities, and other 'smart' objects, and healthcare IT infrastructure are getting immense benefit from edge computing as it helps to prevent application performance latency issues. Sectors like education, law firms, emergency services, travel management, and entertainment management need access to their technology tools anytime, anywhere.

Market scope of EC and CC

The profound amalgamation of 5G networks and IoT devices is bringing about an intense change in the deployment methods of computing workloads. Hence, at this moment, the important thing to consider is to craft state-of-the-art data centres that would offer decades of operating time. Also, edge computing has the potential to perk-up efficacy coupled with appropriate response time gathered by IoT devices and it can also diminish response time. The most important aspect is that edge computing has the capability to reduce the cost of operations, because in this technology a central server is not needed to examine the actions. Data could be stored later

when this is amalgamated with cloud computing and then at the later stage, with the help of big data analytics, data can be processed to drive growth and innovation.

Cloud computing has made it possible for companies to have access to huge amounts of computing resources in a short time with great ease and flexibility, without making costly investments. Cloud computing also allows companies to host platforms, software and databases remotely, which helps in freeing up memory and computational power on the company's individual computers.

On the other hand, edge computing systems spread all stages of data processing between various devices, such as sensors, transponders, cameras, making the whole network safer than a cloud computing network. Moreover, edge computing stores and transfers sensitive or important data remotely, making it safer than it would be on a cloud. Edge-based IoT devices gather and analyse data close to the source, which greatly reduces the transferring time and latency, allowing organisations to utilise the data in real time without any delay. Edge computing needs very less bandwidth and hence can easily operate in conditions with a limited connection, without hampering overall business operations.

Future of EC and CC

With the massive advancement of science and technology, the new-fangled cloud and edge computing will have the full potential to enhance time, offering the ladder of growth and innovation and also decreasing cost of operations and improving the life time of IoT devices. This is also because the world is now moving towards smart devices and hence the demand for these technologies would escalate more. Between 2019 and 2023, Technavio research says, the market for edge computing will increase by 41 per cent CAGR.

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